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And I was like, “Oh my God—I should probably just go to a store and grab one. Even if I order online, I would probably get it next day.” My dad said, “I will do Amazon—it will come in 10 minutes”. So just before I went for a shower, I ordered my razor. By the time I was back, it was at my doorstep. I feel India leans into the pace of innovation much harder and adopts it very quickly.

SZ: What about the availability of delivery people in India—is that key?

A: You could argue that. I mean there are systemic conditions that are conducive to that innovation. The density is higher, the availability of labour is higher, and there’s an established customer habit of calling their local neighbourhood store and ordering things one at a time instead of stocking up a pantry. That’s different from the US, where you do pantry shopping—you buy a lot of goods at the end of the week and then deplete them. In India, apartments are often smaller, so people tend to order things in small batches.

SZ: Recently, Albinder Dhindsa, the CEO of Blinkit said India’s quick commerce bubble may be close to bursting. Is that so?

A: I can talk about our strategy. You know, we are very focused on building a very large and profitable business. And when we enter and offer any service to our customers, we ask ourselves: what are the sustainable unit economics? And when we look at our 10-minute delivery service, we already have a built-out

supply chain. We have a customer base that comes to us for speedy large selection. So, we do not have to invest as much as somebody else might have to create a supply chain or to drive customer acquisition. Our 10-minute service is driving further usage of our existing assets and reducing our costs.

SZ: So, will you be the winner in the long term in quick commerce?

A: Well, I can only tell you that I am very optimistic about our future. I cannot comment on others. Based on what we are seeing in terms of how quickly customers are adopting our service, how it is leading to further downstream impact in terms of greater frequency, and how sustainable the unit economics is for us because of our existing assets, I am very optimistic about our success.

SZ: What are your thoughts on the concerns around the AI use case versus the investments that companies are having to put in?

A: AI is probably the largest disruption of all. And when you have that kind of a disruption, you lean in, all in. And the Amazon strategy is a full stack strategy. We have also launched our foundation models. We are investing in services that make high-performing models—not just ours, accessible to developers so they can build applications.

SZ: There are fears about an AI bubble....

A: Well, I think if you look back at any disruptive moments in history, humans probably overestimate them in the short term and underestimate them in the long run. And as a company that is very focused on the long term. I think in the long term, this will be very rational.

SZ: Finally, how is it working with and for someone like Jeff Bezos?

A: Well, I had the good fortune to be working closely with him as his technical advisor in 2007. And I would say that you really start appreciating how you obsess with customers, how you can really, really think big and invent on behalf of customers, and how you can think long term. So, the foundations of our leadership principles are based on that ability for us to deliver. And I have developed a true appreciation for what true customer obsession, invention and thinking big and long-term thinking looks like. **BT**

@sazarabi